

I found a \$30B ecommerce gold rush nobody's talking about

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Jul 04, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jQZrYyesn9E> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Arie Scherson identifies persimmon-extract deodorizing soap as a fast-trending, nearly competition-free product in the \$30B body-odor market, and walks through sourcing, offer structure, and Shopify launch strategy.

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Who Arie Is & His Credibility 0:24

- Runs a Meta Ads agency; holds **Meta Business Partner status at the highest tier**
- Also building a personal Shopify brand with a partner
 - Goal: \$1 million/month by end of the year
 - Launched 4 months ago; already approximately one-third of the way there (~\$333K/month as of filming)
- Has previously worked closely with Snow (teeth-whitening brand), which successfully capitalized on the Japanese ingredient nano-hydroxyapatite for enamel rebuilding — used as a direct analogy for this opportunity

The Product: Persimmon Deodorizing Soap 0:46

- A natural Japanese cleansing bar formulated with **persimmon (kaki) extract** and green tea
- Key mechanism: tannins in persimmon break down **nonanal** — the lipid compound responsible for age-related body odor

- Effectively neutralizes odors without harsh artificial fragrances or chemicals
- Prized for antioxidant properties
- Solves a massive, universal pain point (body odor) through a unique, science-backed natural mechanism Arie says he had never heard of before
- Parallels drawn to nano-hydroxyapatite: a Japanese ingredient that went from obscure to mainstream — persimmon soap is described as being at the "early stage" of that same trajectory

Market Demand & Trend Evidence 1:35

- Data pulled from **Shopee.ai** — a platform for trending products, exploding topics, sourcing, and courses
- Current monthly search volume: **~49,500–50,000 searches/month** and climbing exponentially
- Arie describes the growth curve as "starting to go exponential" and expects it to continue based on the nano-hydroxyapatite precedent
- Search demand treated as a reliable proxy for real consumer demand

Current Competitors 2:23

- Only **two brands** identified as active in this space at time of filming:

Brand	URL	Monthly Visitors
Asai Japan	asaijapan.com	~20,000
Mai Clinical	(not specified)	~120,000

- Mai Clinical described as "actually crushing it" and having a cool offer
- Competitive landscape still described as having "virtually no good competitors" given the size of the demand opportunity
- Arie notes he would not directly copy these stores but would study the benefits language they use (e.g., referencing nonanal removal and review content)

Offer & Business Model 2:47

- Mai Clinical's current offer: a **4-month supply bundle** — noted as a solid approach
- Arie's preferred model: **recurring subscription** for predictable revenue
 - Can also combine both: high-AOV bundles AND subscription — described as the better long-term structure
- Soap lends itself naturally to repeat purchase (consumable product = built-in recurring revenue)
- Positioned at the intersection of two booming consumer trends: body-odor solutions and natural/chemical-free products

Sourcing Strategy 3:36

- Primary sourcing platform: **Alibaba**
 - Suppliers already manufacturing persimmon soap bars are visible and available
 - Cost: approximately **\$1 per bar**; minimum viable test order ~50 bars for \$50
 - Custom labeling available from the outset even at small quantities
- Can test demand **without holding inventory** first (implied drop-ship/agent model)
- For fulfillment, Arie recommends **Team Drop** (free account)
 - Acts as a sourcing agent with boots on the ground in China
 - Order inventory to a Chinese warehouse and ship worldwide from there
 - Shipping time: approximately **7–10 days** worldwide
 - Communication via WhatsApp — connect the agent directly with your chosen Alibaba supplier
- For Arie's own brand: chose a custom formula and custom product from day one
 - Took longer to launch than a drop-ship store but described as a "much better outcome" long-term
 - Recommends same approach (custom brand) for this opportunity

Launch Framework & Free Resources 3:10

- Step-by-step framework Arie outlines:
 - Step 1 — Build a free Shopify store using the **free store builder** (link in description)
 - Uses the same theme Arie uses for his own brand
 - Includes a **3-month free Shopify trial**
 - No upsells, no catch
 - Step 2 — Create a **free Team Drop account** to get a China-based sourcing agent
 - Connect via WhatsApp with verified Alibaba supplier
 - Step 3 — Source persimmon soap (custom label or white-label) at ~\$1/bar
 - Step 4 — Build offer around subscription and/or bundle (e.g., 4-month supply)
 - Step 5 — Market using Meta Ads (Arie's primary expertise)
- Additional free resource: **Shopee Lab** — Arie's e-commerce community/accelerator
 - Described as "like Y Combinator" but focused on education, data, and courses rather than investment (at this stage)

Market Size & Tailwinds 4:48

- **Body odor/deodorant market size: ~\$30 billion per year**
- Expected growth rate: **5–7% annually over the next decade**
- Natural and chemical-free personal care products are also growing exponentially in parallel
 - Driven by rising consumer awareness of synthetic chemicals in everyday products
 - Persimmon soap sits at the intersection of both mega-trends: odor elimination AND natural formulation

Arie's core insight: persimmon soap solves a massive, universal problem (body odor) through a credible natural mechanism, in a \$30B market with almost no direct competition — the same setup nano-hydroxyapatite had before it went mainstream.

Arie's Longer-Term Vision 6:43

- Not personally pursuing this brand — fully focused on his existing Shopify brand and agency
- Agency intentionally kept small ("handful of clients") to maintain focus on brand-building and teaching
- Long-term vision: spot early-stage trends like this one, share them publicly, and eventually invest in promising ideas at an early stage (not currently)
- Motivation for sharing: genuinely enjoys teaching inside Shoppee Lab and sees spotting winning products as a core skill he wants to help others develop
- Emphasis: building a real brand with a custom product and recurring revenue is superior to drop-shipping or calorie-arbitrage tactics for long-term skill development and business value